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Table 1.4: Systems of Classification			
Two Kingdom	**Three Kingdom**	**Four Kingdom**	**Five Kingdom**
 **Carl Linnaeus (1735)**	 **Ernst Haeckel (1866)**	 **Copeland (1956)**	 **R.H. Whittaker (1969)**
1. Plantae 2. Animalia	1. Protista 2. Plantae 3. Animalia	1. Monera 2. Protista 3. Plantae 4. Animalia	1. Monera 2. Protista 3. Fungi 4. Plantae 5. Animalia

1.3.3 Five Kingdom Classification

R.H.Whittaker, an American taxonomist proposed five Kingdom classification in the year 1969. The Kingdoms include **Monera, Protista, Fungi, Plantae and Animalia** (Figure 1.7). The criteria adopted for the classification include cell structure, thallus organization, mode of nutrition, reproduction and phylogenetic relationship**.** A comparative account of the salient features of each Kingdom is given in Table 1.5

Merits

- The classification is based on the complexity of cell structure and organization of thallus.
- It is based on the mode of nutrition
- Separation of fungi from plants
- It shows the phylogeny of the organisms

Demerits

- The Kingdom Monera and protista accommodate both autotrophic and heterotrophic organisms, cell wall lacking and cell wall bearing organisms thus making these two groups more heterogeneous.
- Viruses were not included in the system.

Carl Woese and co-workers in the year 1990 introduced three domains of life *viz.*, **Bacteria**, **Archaea** and **Eukarya** based on the difference in rRNA nucleotide sequence, lipid structure of the cell membrane. A revised six Kingdom classification for living world was proposed by Thomas Cavalier-Smith in the year 1998 and the Kingdom **Monera** is divided in to **Archaebacteria** and **Eubacteria.** Recently Ruggerio *et al.*, 2015 published a seven Kingdom classification which is a practical extension of Thomas Cavalier's six Kingdom scheme. According to this classification there are two SuperKingdoms (**Prokaryota** and **Eukaryota**) **Prokaryota** include